Griffith Barracks
Multi-Denominational School
(GBMDS)

Admissions Policy

September 2025

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1. Griffith Barracks Multi-Denominational School Admission Policy

This policy is published by the Board of Management (BOM) pursuant to Section 15(d) of the Education Act, 1998 (as amended by the Education (Admissions to Schools) Act 2018), and sets out the procedures governing admission of children to Griffith Barracks Multi-Denominational School

This policy sets out the Admission policy effective for the admission of children to Griffith Barracks Multi-Denominational School (GBMDS), after the start of the 2020/2021 school year and supersedes any previous policies. This policy has been approved by the Patron following a consultation process with the parents/guardians and staff of GBMDS initiated by the BOM.

2. Characteristic spirit and general objectives of GBMDS

GBMDS operates under the patronage of the Griffith Barracks Multi-Denominational School Ltd. a company limited by guarantee that is also a member of Educate Together. GBMDS is a National School and adheres to the regulations and programmes set down by the Department of Education and Skills (DES).

GBMDS embraces the Educate Together Ethos which has the following core principles; an Educate Together School is:

- **Child Centred**
- **Equality Based**
- **Co-Educational**
- **Democratically Run**

GBMDS operates two classes in each year.

GBMDS does not have a defined catchment area. Places are offered to children based on the criteria outlined in this policy until classes are deemed by the Board of Management to be full. The Board's decision as to what constitutes a full class for any year depends on a range of factors including, but not limited to:

- Optimal pupil/teacher ratios
- Quality of education
- Specific educational needs of pupils
- Health and safety
- Available resources
- DES guidelines

GBMDS shall not discriminate in its admission of a pupil to the school on the basis of gender, civil status, family status, sexual orientation, religion, disability, race, Traveller community background or special educational needs of a pupil, or applicant parent of the pupil concerned.

3. Admission Procedures

3.1 Admission of pupils

The school shall admit each pupil seeking admission except where –

a) GBMDS is oversubscribed (see Section 4)

b) A parent of a pupil, when required by the principal, in accordance with section 23(4) of the Education (Welfare) Act 2000, fails to confirm in writing that the code of behaviour of the school is acceptable to him or her and that he or she shall make all reasonable efforts to ensure compliance with such code by the pupil. Click here for our Code of Conduct (Positive Behaviour Policy)

c) A pupil is less than 4 years of age on the 1st September of the year commencing Junior Infants.

d) The board of management has a duty of care to ensure as far as practicable the health and safety of the students and staff of the school. In addition, the Board of Management is required under section 15(1) of the Education Act 1998 to provide, or cause to be provided, an appropriate education for each student at the school for which that board has responsibility. An application for admission may be refused, therefore, where the admission of the applicant would, in the reasonable opinion of the school, pose a significant risk to the health and safety of the applicant or students and staff of the school, or risk significantly interfering with the right of other students to an appropriate education.

3.2 What will not be considered or taken into account

In accordance with section 62(7)(e) of the Education Act 1998 (as amended), GBMDS will not consider or take into account any of the following in deciding on applications for admission or when placing a pupil on a waiting list for admission to the school:

(a) a pupil's address, as the school does not have a defined catchment area;
(b) a pupil's prior attendance at a pre-school or pre-school service, including naíonraí;
(c) the payment of fees or contributions (howsoever described) to GBMDS;
(d) a pupil's academic ability, skills or aptitude;
(e) the occupation, financial status, academic ability, skills or aptitude of a pupil's parents/guardians;
(f) a requirement that a pupil, or his or her parents/guardians, attend an interview, open day or other meeting as a condition of admission;
(g) a pupil's connection to GBMDS by virtue of a parent or grandparent attending GBMDS;
(h) the date and time on which an application for admission was received by GBMDS.

This is subject to the application being received at any time during the period specified for receiving applications set out in the annual admission notice of the school for the year commencing Junior Infants and the period specified for the receipt of applications set out in the annual admission notice for all other classes.

For the school year 2020-21 onwards the following procedures will be in place in the case of oversubscription.

4. Admission Process

4.1 Junior Infants

Any parent who wishes their child to be considered for entry to Junior Infants can access an application form on our school website at https://griffithbarracks.ie/Page/Admissions/3730/Index.html%20. Children can only be on one application list at a time. The list opens on 1st October at 09:00 for entry to the school for the following academic year and closes on 31st October at 23:59.

In the event that the school is oversubscribed, the school will, when deciding on applications for admission, apply the following selection criteria in the order listed below to those applications that are received within the timeline for receipt of applications as set out in the school's annual admission notice for Junior Infants.

Please note that when GBMDS is oversubscribed, the only criteria that will be taken into account when allocating places in the school, are those detailed in this policy.

Priority Category 1:
Applicant pupils who are qualifying siblings of children currently in the school and children of staff currently working in the school who will be 4 years of age on or before 1st April of the year commencing Junior Infants, in line with the age of other children starting in the school that year.

Priority Category 2:
Pupils who reach 4 years of age on or before 1st April of the year commencing Junior Infants.

Priority Category 3:
Siblings of children currently in the school and children of staff currently working in the school who reach 4 years of age on or before 1st September of the year commencing Junior Infants.

Priority Category 4:
All other pupils who reach 4 years of age on or before the first of September of the year of commencing Junior Infants.

Where demand exceeds places available, GBMDS operates a transparently held lottery for entry to Junior Infants based on the following process. Parents of applicants are welcome to observe this process.

- Each application will be given a random number (with twins being given consecutive numbers). These numbers will make up the application list.
- When all applications have been numbered, the places will be offered based on the allocated number, lowest number first, until the class is full.
- Should places in the class become available later, they will be offered from the application list, lowest number first.
- Parents will be informed of their number by email

The Board of Management may exercise discretion in exceptional cases.

4.2 Other year groups – Senior Infants to 6th Class

Any parent who wishes their child to be considered for entry to a class other than Junior Infants can access an application form for the appropriate class on our school website at https://griffithbarracks.ie/Page/Admissions/3730/Index.html . It is also important to ring the school at this time to let us know if you have any particular needs or requirements. Children can only be on one application list at a time. The list opens on 1st October at 09:00 for entry to the school for the following academic year and closes on 31st October at 23:59pm.

Priority Category 1: Siblings of children currently in the school and children of staff currently in the school. In the event that there are two or more siblings tied for a place or places in this selection criteria category (the number of applicants exceeds the number of remaining places), places will be added to a waiting list, by way of a lottery of completed applications.

Priority Category 2: All other applicants.
A second lottery will take place after the available places have been filled from priority category 1 above. Applicants will be allocated a number on the list in the order in which they were drawn from the lottery. Parents/guardians will be informed that their child's name is on this list and of their number on the waiting list.

Priority Category 3: Anybody applying after the lottery has taken place will be added to a waiting list in order of the date of their application.

The Board of Management may exercise discretion in exceptional cases.

Waiting lists for classes Senior Infants - 6th class will expire on 30th September of the following year.

4.3 Children with Special Educational Needs

GBMDS welcomes all children to the school. Parents/guardians of children with special educational needs apply for a place at GBMDS in exactly the same way as everyone else - the same Admission Policy and procedures apply. Children with special educational needs are offered places in GBMDS on the same basis as applies to all other applicants.

In the case of children with special educational needs seeking to enter GBMDS after junior infants, material to be provided will include reports from his/her current school. The offer of a place in GBMDS to such a child will be contingent on the availability of places in the appropriate class. GBMDS has a policy for children with additional educational needs. It is available upon request.

The Board of Management will endeavour to have all resources and support in place before a child with special needs is admitted to the school. This may include visiting teacher service, resource teacher, special needs assistants, specialised equipment or furniture, transport services etc.

Parents of children with identified special needs wishing to enrol in GBMDS are strongly encouraged to write to the school prior to accepting a place, setting out in detail the child's special needs and furnishing the school with any relevant reports to help establish the educational needs of the child and to profile the support services required.

The Principal will meet with the parents of the child to discuss the school's suitability for the child. If necessary, a full case conference may be called including all relevant parties as appropriate.

5. Late Applications to Junior Infants

All applications for admission received after the closing date on 31st October, as outlined in the Annual Admission Notice for Junior Infants will be considered and decided upon in date order of when they were received in accordance with our school's Admissions Policy, the Education Admissions to School Act 2018 and any regulations made under that Act.

In the event that there is no place, the name of the applicant will be added to the waiting list.

6. Late Applications to Senior Infants - 6th Class

In the event of oversubscription, placement on the waiting list for GBMDS is in the order of priority assigned to the applications after the school has applied the selection criteria in accordance with this Admission Policy (see Section 4). Late applications made after 31st October will be added to the list in the order in which they were received.

Waiting lists for classes Senior Infants - 6th Class will expire on 30th September of the following year.

7. Admission of pupils after the commencement of the school year

If a place is available after the commencement of the school year in which admission is sought, the place will be offered to the next applicant on the waiting list.

8. Decisions on applications

All decisions on applications for admission to GBMDS will be based on the following:

- The school Admission Policy
- The school Annual Admission Notice
- The information provided by the applicant in the school's official application form received during the period specified in our Annual Admission Notice.

Selection criteria that are not included in the school Admission Policy will not be used to make a decision on an application for a place in our school.

9. Notifying applicants of decisions

Successful applicants will be informed in writing by email and followed up by post where an Irish postal address has been supplied, as to the decision of the school within the timeline outlined in the relevant Annual Admission Notice but no later than three weeks after the annual Admission process.
Applicants will be informed of the right to seek a review and of the right of appeal of the school's decision (see Section 13).

10. Circumstances in which offers may not be made or may be withdrawn

An offer of admission may not be made or may be withdrawn by GBMDS where -

(i) it is established that information contained in the application is false or misleading.

(ii) an applicant fails to confirm acceptance of an offer of admission on or before the date set out in the Annual Admission Notice of the school.

(iii) the parent of a pupil, when required by the principal in accordance with section 23(4) of the Education (Welfare) Act 2000, fails to confirm in writing that the code of behaviour of the school is acceptable to him or her and that he or she shall make all reasonable efforts to ensure compliance with such code by the pupil.

(iv) The board of management has a duty of care to ensure as far as practicable the health and safety of the students and staff of the school. In addition, the board of management is required under section 15(1) of the Education Act 1998 to provide, or cause to be provided, an appropriate education for each student at the school for which that board has responsibility. An application for admission may be refused, therefore, where the admission of the applicant would, in the reasonable opinion of the school, pose a significant risk to the health and safety of the applicant or students and staff of the school, or risk significantly interfering with the right of other students to an appropriate education.

11. Sharing of data with other schools

Applicants should be aware that section 66(6) of the Education (Admission to Schools) Act 2018 allows for the sharing of certain information between schools in order to facilitate the efficient admission of pupils. Section 66(6) allows a school to provide a patron or another board of management with a list of pupils in relation to whom-

(i) An application for admission to the school has been received
(ii) An offer of admission to the school has been made, or
(iii) An offer of admission to the school has been accepted.
(iv) The list may include any of the following:
(v) The date on which an application for admission was received by the school
(vi) The date on which an offer of admission was made by the school
(vii) The date on which an offer of admission was accepted by an applicant
(viii) A pupil's personal details including his or her name, address, date of birth and personal public service number (within the meaning of section 262 of the Social Welfare Consolidation Act 2005)

12. Declaration in relation to the non-charging of fees

The BOM of GBMDS or any persons acting on its behalf will not charge fees for or seek payment or contributions (howsoever described) as a condition of-

(a) an application for admission of a child to GBMDS, or
(b) the admission or continued admission of a pupil in GBMDS.

13. Reviews/appeals

Review of decisions by the Board of Management

The parent of the pupil may request the BOM to review a decision to refuse admission. Such requests must be made in accordance with section 29C of the Education Act 1998.
The timeline within which such a review must be requested and the other requirements applicable to such reviews are set out in the procedures determined by the Minister under section 29B of the Education Act 1998 which are published on the website of the Department of Education and Skills.

The BOM will conduct such reviews in accordance with the requirements of the procedures determined under section 29B and with section 29C of the Education Act 1998.

13.1 Request to Review

Note: Where an applicant has been refused admission due to the school being oversubscribed, the applicant **must request a review** of that decision by the Board of Management prior to making an appeal under section 29 of the Education Act 1998.

Where an applicant has been refused admission due to a reason other than the school being oversubscribed, the applicant **must request a review** of that decision by the board of management prior to making an appeal under section 29 of the Education Act 1998.

Requests for reviews can be sent to the

13.2 Right of appeal

Under Section 29 of the Education Act 1998, the parent of the pupil may appeal a decision of the school to refuse admission.
An appeal may be made under section 29 (1)(c)(i) of the Education Act 1998 where the refusal to admit was due to the school being oversubscribed.
An appeal may be made under section 29 (1)(c)(ii) of the Education Act 1998 where the refusal to admit was due to a reason other than the school being oversubscribed.

Appeals under section 29 of the Education Act 1998 will be considered and determined by an independent appeals committee appointed by the Minister for Education and Skills.

The timeline within which such an appeal must be made and the other requirements applicable to such appeals are set out in the procedures determined by the Minister under section 29B of the Education Act 1998 which are published on the website of the Department of Education and Skills.

14. Data protection

GBMDS acknowledges its obligations as a data controller under the Data Protection Acts 1988 - 2018 and the EU General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR). Information obtained for the purpose of allocating places in the school to pupils will only be used and disclosed in a manner which is compatible with this purpose. Only such personal data as are relevant and necessary for the performance of this function will be retained. The school undertakes to ensure that such information is processed fairly, that it is kept safe, secure, accurate, complete, and up to date. Individuals have the right to have any inaccurate information rectified or erased. All data submitted as part of the application form, and which will not form part of annual school records, will be destroyed at the end of the application process. A copy of all personal data obtained and kept as part of the admission process will be made available to the subject of such data on receipt of a written request to the chairperson of the Board of Management.

15. Procedure for offering places

Letter of Offer and Registration Forms - Following the Closing Date and the subsequent lottery process, the school will send out offers of places by email and post to successful applicants. Acceptance of the offer must be received by the school, via email or post, by the date and time specified in the Letter of Offer (the **"Registration Date"**). On acceptance of the offer, a link to an online registration form will be sent, which needs to be completed by the parent/guardian within a week of receipt of the form. This forms part of your acceptance of the place. Any recent assessments for the child(ren) should also be included at this time.

Parents/guardians should also provide any other documentation, which may be specified in the Letter of Offer (as approved by the Board of Management).

Parents/guardians must complete the Registration Forms by the Registration Date together with any required documentation, otherwise the offer will lapse, and the place be offered to the next child on the Waiting List.

16. Change of Address Reminder

PARENTS/GUARDIANS ARE REMINDED THAT IT IS ESSENTIAL THAT THEY KEEP GBMDS INFORMED OF ANY CHANGE OF ADDRESS OR CONTACT NUMBERS. CHANGES OF ADDRESS MUST BE NOTIFIED IN WRITING TO THE ADMISSIONS OFFICER OF THE SCHOOL.

17. Appendix (1)

A "Qualifying Sibling/Staff Member's Child" means a child:

- Whose application is received in the appropriate enrolment period each year.
- who is either:

(a) the sibling of another child who is enrolled as a pupil in GBMDS and will remain so enrolled for the academic year. For the avoidance of doubt, sibling relationships shall include any family members who are adopted and/or fostered, step or half siblings.

(b) who is the child of a current staff member of GBMDS who has been employed for at least one year in the school on the date of receipt of application and is still employed in the school on the Registration Date (as defined below) of that child.

18. Griffith Barracks Multi-Denominational School

ANNUAL ADMISSION NOTICE

for the 2026/2027 school year

Admission Policy and Application Form

A copy of the school's **Admission Policy** for the year 2026/2027 is available to download at: www.griffithbarracks.ie or on request by writing to Griffith Barracks Multi-Denominational School, The Old Guardhouse, S.C.R., Dublin 8 or emailing: office@griffithbarracks.ie
Admissions Forms are completed online only at
https://griffithbarracks.ie/Page/Admissions/3730/Index.html

PART 1:

Application and Decision Dates for admission to GBMDS for the school year 2026/2027

The following are the dates applicable for admission to Junior Infants

1. The school will commence accepting applications for admission on:	1st October at 09:00
2. The school shall cease accepting applications for admission on:	31st October at 23:59
3. The date by which applicants will be notified of the decision on their application is:	Within 3 weeks of the closing date for applications
4. The period within which applicants must confirm acceptance of an offer of admission is:	Within one week of the offer being made

Note: applications made after the enrolment period will be processed as late applications, the school will consider and issue decisions on late applications in accordance with the school's admission policy.

Failure of an applicant to accept an offer within one week of the offer being made may result in the offer being withdrawn.

Other Year Groups Application and Decision Dates for the school year 2026/2027

The following are the dates applicable for admission to **other year groups (Senior Infants to 6th Class)**

1. The school will commence accepting applications for admission to other year groups on	1st October at 09:00
2. The school shall cease accepting applications for admission to other year groups on	31st October at 23:59
3. The date by which applicants will be notified of the decision on their application is	As places become available in year groups other than Junior Infants
4. The period within which applicants must confirm acceptance of an offer of admission is	One full week after the offer

Note: applications made after 31st October at 23:59 will be processed as Late Applications. The school will consider and issue decisions on late applications in accordance with the school's admission policy.

Failure of an applicant to accept an offer by one week after the offer has been made may result in the offer being withdrawn.

Information about the number of places that will be available in the next school year 2026 -2027

The number of available places in Junior Infants will be:	**51**
The number of available places in other year groups will be decided closer to the time or if a place comes up in a particular class.	
Senior Infants	**To be decided as places become available**
1st Class	**To be decided as places become available**
2nd Class	**To be decided as places become available**
3rd Class	**To be decided as places become available**
4th Class	**To be decided as places become available**
5th Class	**To be decided as places become available**
6th Class	**To be decided as places become available**

PART 2:

(This section should only be completed if your school intake group/special class/other year group was oversubscribed in the previous school year)

Information regarding the admission process for the Intake Group for Junior Infants/other year group for the 2025/2026 school year

In respect of the 2024-2025 school year, prior to that to which the admission notice applies, the total number of applications for admission received by the school was 265

Breakdown of places allocated for the 2025/2026 school year:	
Number of places available:	52
Number of applications received:	265
Number of Offers made and accepted under each criteria:	Number of sibling/children of staff member places offered: 20 Number accepted: 20
	Number of all other places offered: 100 Number of places accepted: 31
Total number of offers made	120
Number of names placed on waiting list for the school year concerned.	123

Ratified by the Board of Management
on 30/04/2020

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